



Q

What is the recommended headspace to leave when canning fruits in jars?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

1/2 inch headspace

FUN FACT

Leaving the right headspace helps create a good seal and prevents food spoilage.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

Q

Why does the hot pack method of canning fruit usually produce better quality than raw pack?

CANNING FRUITS



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

It packs fruit heated in syrup or juice to soften and remove air.

FUN FACT

Heating fruit first reduces air and helps fruit keep color and flavor.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Q

How long should you boil jars of apples in a water bath canner at 0-1000 ft altitude using the hot pack method?

CANNING FRUITS



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

20 minutes

FUN FACT

Boiling for the correct time kills bacteria and ensures safe food.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Q

What must you add to can Asian pears to ensure safe acidity for boiling water canning?

CANNING FRUITS



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

2 tablespoons bottled lemon juice per quart

FUN FACT

Asian pears are lower in acid and need lemon juice to be safely canned.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

Q

When preheating jars for water bath canning fruit, what temperature should you heat water to for raw-packed fruit?

CANNING FRUITS



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

140°F

FUN FACT

Preheating jars helps prevent breakage during canning.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Q

What is a safe way to prevent fruit like apples and pears from darkening before canning?

CANNING FRUITS



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Soak them in ascorbic acid solution before draining.

FUN FACT

Ascorbic acid keeps fruit looking fresh and bright after cutting.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Teens (14–18)

Q

Why is it important not to retighten screw bands after processing jars of canned fruit?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Retightening can cut through the gasket and cause seal failure.

FUN FACT

Leave bands snug but don't retighten to keep the jar sealed properly.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

Q

When processing fruit in a boiling water canner, how far above the jars should the water level be?

CANNING FRUITS



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

1 to 2 inches above jar tops

FUN FACT

Keeping water above jars ensures even heating and safe canning.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

Q

What is recommended to do if a jar does not seal after processing?

CANNING FRUITS



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Refrigerate and use soon or reprocess within 24 hours with a new lid.

FUN FACT

Reprocessing jars keeps your canned fruit safe and reduces waste.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

Q

For berries, how long should you heat them in boiling water before packing in the hot pack method?

CANNING FRUITS



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

30 seconds

FUN FACT

Quick heating preserves berry texture better than long boiling.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Q

What type of jars is recommended for home canning fruit?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Standard Mason-type jars designed for home canning

FUN FACT

Mason jars are made to withstand the heat and pressure of canning.

Source: PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products

Q

Why do you add syrup, water, or juice to canned fruit jars before sealing?

CANNING FRUITS



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

To cover the fruit and maintain quality during processing and storage.

FUN FACT

Liquid helps conduct heat evenly and keeps fruit from drying out.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

Q

What happens if you stop the boil during water bath canning before processing time is complete?

CANNING FRUITS



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

You must bring it back to a boil and start timing over from the beginning.

FUN FACT

Consistent boiling kills harmful microorganisms for safe preservation.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Teens (14–18)

Q

How long should plums be boiled in syrup before packing for hot pack canning?

CANNING FRUITS



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

2 minutes

FUN FACT

Brief boiling helps soften plums and prevent splitting in jars.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Q

What is the recommended liquid headspace for fruit purees when canning?

CANNING FRUITS



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

1/4 inch

FUN FACT

Less headspace reduces air that can spoil pureed fruit in jars.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Teens (14–18)

Q

What is the major safety reason white-flesh peaches are not recommended for boiling water canning?

CANNING FRUITS



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

They have a higher pH and may not be safe for boiling water canning.

FUN FACT

Safety always comes first - some fruits need other preservation methods.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Q

If you want to freeze canned food instead of reprocessing a failed seal, what headspace should you allow?

CANNING FRUITS



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

11/2 inches headspace

FUN FACT

Extra space prevents jar breakage from expansion when frozen.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Q

Why do you add bottled lemon juice to jars before canning some fruits like pears or figs?

CANNING FRUITS



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

To increase acidity for safe boiling water canning.

FUN FACT

Acid helps prevent growth of harmful bacteria in canned fruit.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Teens (14–18)

Q

What is a sign that a jar lid has sealed properly after canning?

CANNING FRUITS



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

The lid is concave and does not move when pressed in the center.

FUN FACT

A good seal keeps your fruit safe and fresh for months.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Teens (14–18)

Q

How long should cherries be processed in a boiling water canner at altitudes below 1000 feet with a raw pack?

CANNING FRUITS



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

25 minutes

FUN FACT

Correct processing time kills bacteria found naturally on fruit.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits